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# SAMAGRA SHIKSHA KERALA
# ANNUAL EVALUATION 2024-2025

808

## ENGLISH

**Time : 1½ Hrs**

**Std : VIII**

**Total Score: 40**

**INSTRUCTIONS:**

- 15 minutes is given as cool off time.
- This time is to be used for reading the question paper.
- You are not supposed to write anything during the cool off time.
- Attempt the questions according to the instructions.

**Questions 1 - 5: Read the passage from 'The School for Sympathy' and answer the questions that follow.** **(5 x 1 = 5)**

'The real aim of this school is not to teach thought but thoughtfulness, humanity, kindness and citizenship. That is the ideal I have always had, and happily there are parents good enough to trust me to try and put it into practice. Look out of the window a minute, will you?'

I went to the window, which looked out on a large garden and playground at the back.

'What do you see?' Miss Beam asked.

'I see some very beautiful grounds,' I said, 'and a lot of jolly children. But what surprises me, and pains me too, is that they are not at all healthy and active. As I came in I saw one poor little thing being led about because of some trouble with her eyes. And now I can see two more in the same condition, while there is a girl with a crutch just under the window watching the others at play. She seems to be a hopeless cripple.' Miss Beam laughed.

'Oh, no,' she said, 'She is not lame really; this is only her lame day. Nor are those others blind, it is only their blind day.'

I must have looked very much astonished, for she laughed again.

1. What is the aim of Miss Beam's school?
2. What surprises and pains the narrator when he looks at the children?
3. What was the girl with the crutch under the window doing?
4. Find out the word from the passage which means 'to surprise somebody very much'.
5. Identify the Noun Phrase in the subject position from the sentence given below.
   I see some very beautiful grounds.

**Questions 6 - 9: Read the following lines from the poem 'My Grandmother's House' and answer the questions that follow.** **(4x1=4)**

There is a house now far away where once
I received love... That woman died,
The house withdrew into silence, snakes moved

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Among books, I was then too young
To read, and my blood turned cold like the moon.
How often I think of going
There, to peer through blind eyes of windows or
Just listen to the frozen air,
Or in wild despair pick an armful of
Darkness to bring it here to lie
Behind my bedroom door like a brooding
Dog .....

6. What did the poet receive from her grandmother?

7. What happened to the house after the death of the poet's grandmother?

8. What does the expression 'an armful of darkness' imply?

9. Pick out an instance of simile from the above lines.

**Questions 10 - 14: Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.** **(5 x 1 = 5)**

It was a stormy night when Anna heard a knock on her cottage door. She hesitated - who would visit at this hour? Gathering her courage, she opened the door to find a pale, cloaked stranger with piercing grey eyes. "Please, help me," he whispered, collapsing onto her floor. Anna dragged him inside and tended to his wounds, which were deep and fresh, as if from a fight. "What happened?" she asked, but the man only muttered, "They're after me."

Before Anna could ask more, the sound of hoof beats thundered outside. Lanterns flickered as shadowy figures surrounded the cottage. "Hand him over!" a gruff voice commanded. Anna's heart raced. She turned to the stranger. "Who are you?"

"I cannot explain," he said, his voice firm despite his injuries. "But if you trust me, you must hide me." Against her better judgement, Anna hid him in her cellar. When the men barged in, she lied, claiming she had seen no one. They searched her home but left empty-handed.

When Anna returned to the cellar, the stranger was gone. In his place lay a single black feather and a note: "You saved more than a man tonight. The world owes you."

From that day, Anna noticed strange things - storms avoided her home, crops grew bountifully, and her village prospered. She never learned the stranger's full story, but she knew she had played a part in something far greater than herself.

10. What did Anna hear on a stormy night?

11. How does the author describe the stranger?

12. Where did Anna hide the stranger?

13. What was the note the stranger left in the cellar?

14. What were the strange things that happened in Anna's life after the stranger left her home?

15. **Prepare a profile of Han Kang using the details given below.** **(1 x 4 =4 )**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Birth | : | 27 November 1970 |
| Nationality | : | South Korean |

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| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Famous as | : | Short story writer, poet, novelist |
| Notable works | : | *The Vegetarian, Greek Lessons, The White Book* |
| Awards | : | International Booker Prize (2016), Nobel Prize for Literature (2024) |

**Questions 16 - 19 : Answer any THREE of the following.** **( 3 x 4 = 12)**

16. The boy in the story 'A Day in the Country' is greatly moved by the affection and care of Terenty, the cobbler. Write a **short paragraph** about the boy's day with him.

17. The bold initiative taken by Rosa Parks moved a million minds. Prepare the **character sketch** of Rosa Parks.

18. The writer E.V. Lucas is greatly touched by the thoughtfulness, humanity, kindness and love shown by the students to each other in the school run by Miss Beam. He writes a letter to one of his friends describing his experiences in Miss Beam's school. Prepare the likely **letter.**

19. The English Club of your school has decided to stage the play 'The Merchant of Venice.' As the secretary of the club, you are assigned to prepare the notice. Draft the likely **notice.**

**Questions 20-23: Study the table and answer the questions that follow.** **( 4 x 1=4)**

| Name | Language | Award | Famuos as | Year of Birth |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Indira Parthasarathy | Tamil | Padma Shri | Playwright | 1930 |
| Sarah Joseph | Malayalam | Kerala Sahitya Akademi Award | Novelist | 1946 |
| Mahadevi Varma | Hindi | Padma Bhushan | Poet | 1907 |
| Vinesh Antani | Gujarati | Sahitya Akademi Award | Novelist | 1946 |
| Namdeo Laxman Dhasal | Marathi | Padma Shri | Poet | 1949 |

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20. Who is the recipient of the Padma Bhushan Award among the writers listed above?

21. Name the writers who were born in the same year.

22. In which language did Mahadevi Varma write ?

23. Name the poet who was born after Indian independence.

**24. Edit the following.** **(3 x 1 =3)**

The Captain (a) ***the of Guards*** was a tall, well-built, (b) ***red-hared*** man of about twenty-five. He **(c)** ***were*** handsomely dressed in his gold-braided uniform.

**25. Fill in the blanks with the correct word from the brackets.** **(3 x 1 =3)**

Terenty comes —— (a) of the kitchen garden and begins striding down ——— (b) village street. He walks quickly without stopping —— (c) looking from side to side.

**(by, out, the, or)**